ONE PAINFUL PROBLEM · SERIES 1 · AGENT 3 · RECORD-TO-REPORT

The year that won't stay closed

You filed last year's return from your final trial balance. The client's books kept changing. A free tool that compares the two in a minute and says what each change means for the return.



Series 1 · Agent 3: The year that won't stay closed

You prepared a client's 2025 return from your final trial balance, and filed it in March. The client's books stayed open, because they are the client's books. Some time that summer, someone deleted a $4,250 December deposit from 2025.

Nothing announces it. Months later the new year's work starts from balances that no longer exist. Opening cash is $4,250 short of the Schedule L you filed, and last year's sales in the books no longer match the return. The question is no longer "what is the number" but "what happened, and when".

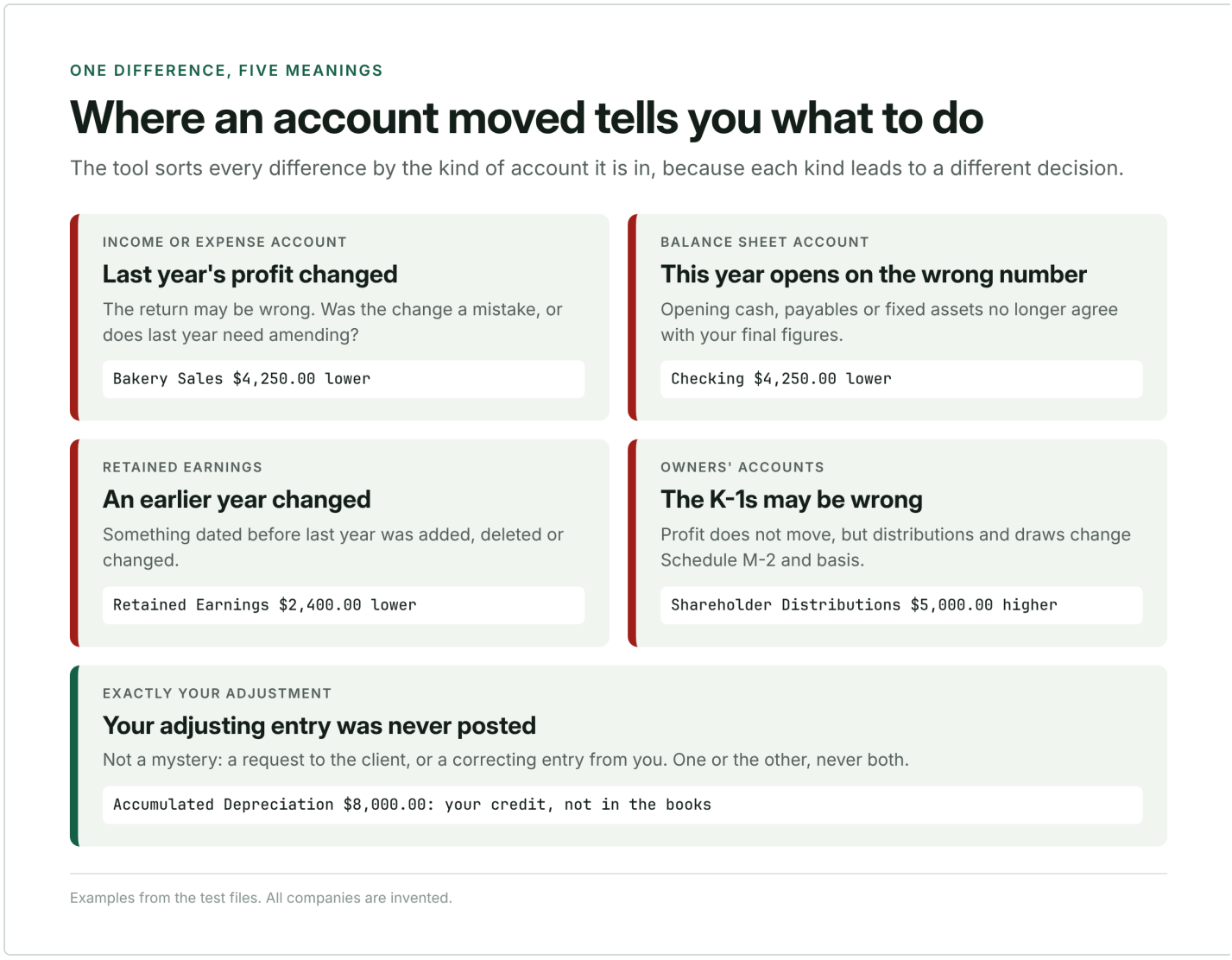
That client, Harbor Light Bakery, is invented; it is one of our test files. The rule is not: the IRS instructions for Form 1120-S say of Schedule L, "The balance sheets should agree with the corporation's books and records" (IRS). This is Series 1, Agent 3. Each series builds five small agents, one for each process accountants run for clients, and each takes one painful step off the desk. This one is for the start of a new year in Record-to-Report: proving last year's books still say what you filed.

What practitioners describe

A preparer on the Intuit Accountants Community, trying to finish a return: "The owner deleted several transactions. they are correct now, however the beginning balance is different" (thread). Another, asked why a balance sheet would not tie: "Tie out ALL numbers the the trial balance, and you'll find the error" (thread).

That tie-out is the job. Line up two trial balances, account by account, and work out what each difference means. QuickBooks and Xero can list transactions changed after a closing date. They cannot compare the books with *your* final figures, which often include adjusting entries that live only in your workpapers.

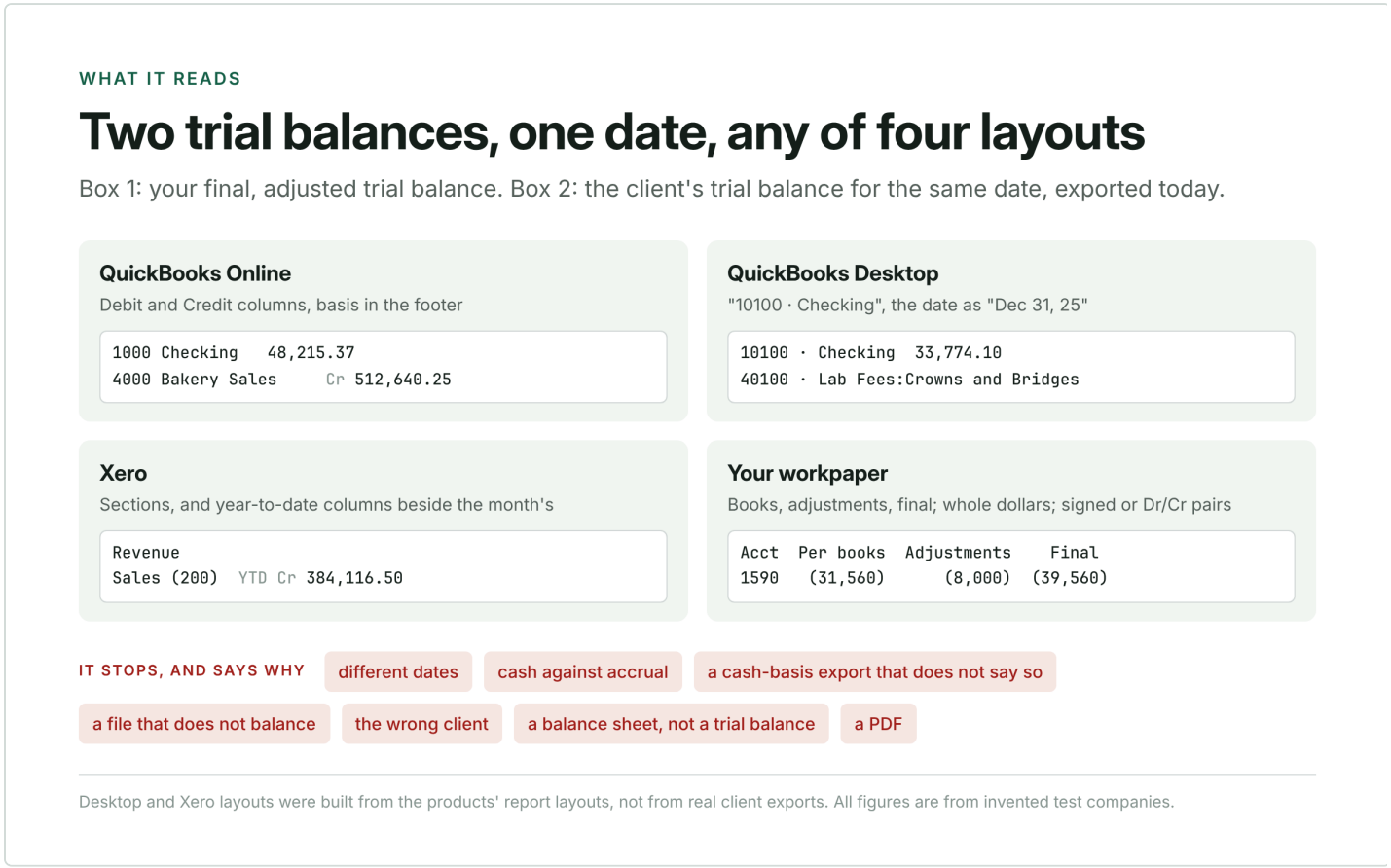
Where an account moved tells you what to do



The same $4,250 means different things depending on where it lands. - **In an income or expense account,** last year's profit changed, and the question is whether to amend. - **In a balance sheet account,** this year opens on the wrong number. - **In retained earnings,** a year before last changed. - **In a distribution or draw,** profit does not move but the K-1s and basis do. - **If the difference is exactly one of your own adjusting entries,** it is not a mystery at all: the client never posted it.

The tool sorts every difference that way. On Harbor Light it says: "Checking and Bakery Sales are both $4,250.00 lower: it looks like a deposit or sale in last year was deleted or voided."

What it reads, and what comes back

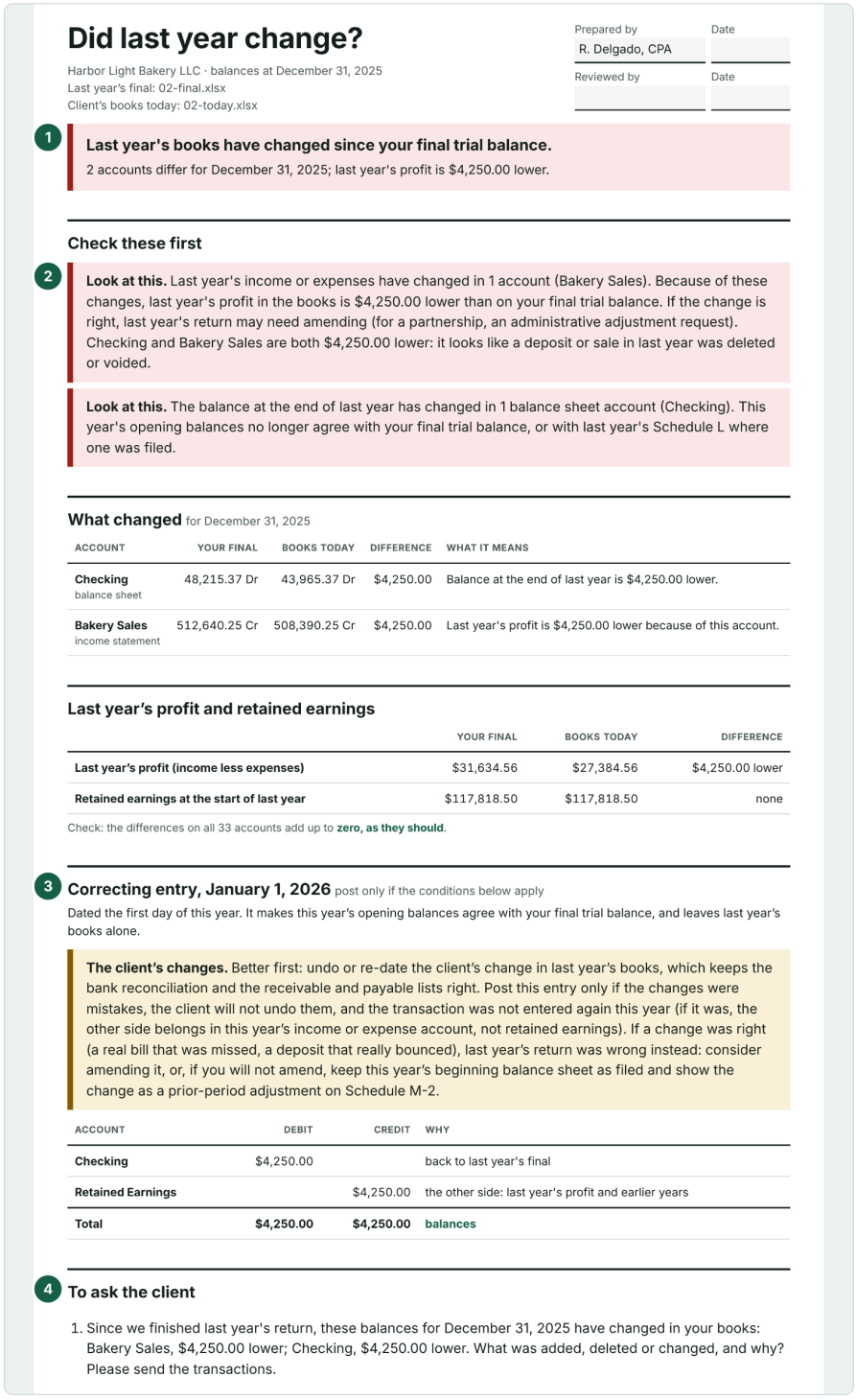


You drop in two files, both Excel or CSV: - **Box 1:** last year's final trial balance; - **Box 2:** a trial balance for the same date, exported from the client's books today.

It reads QuickBooks Online, QuickBooks Desktop and Xero exports, and a workpaper with books, adjustments and final columns in whole dollars. It runs in the browser, uploads nothing, and does its arithmetic in whole cents in code.

WHAT COMES BACK

A workpaper, an entry, and the question for the client



Did last year change?

Prepared by: R. Delgado, CPA — Date:
Reviewed by: — Date:

Harbor Light Bakery LLC · balances at December 31, 2025
Last year's final: 02-final.xlsx
Client's books today: 02-today.xlsx

1 **Last year's books have changed since your final trial balance.**
2 accounts differ for December 31, 2025; last year's profit is $4,250.00 lower.

Check these first

2 **Look at this.** Last year's income or expenses have changed in 1 account (Bakery Sales). Because of these changes, last year's profit in the books is $4,250.00 lower than on your final trial balance. If the change is right, last year's return may need amending (for a partnership, an administrative adjustment request). Checking and Bakery Sales are both $4,250.00 lower: it looks like a deposit or sale in last year was deleted or voided.

Look at this. The balance at the end of last year has changed in 1 balance sheet account (Checking). This year's opening balances no longer agree with your final trial balance, or with last year's Schedule L where one was filed.

What changed for December 31, 2025

ACCOUNT	YOUR FINAL	BOOKS TODAY	DIFFERENCE	WHAT IT MEANS
Checking balance sheet	48,215.37 Dr	43,965.37 Dr	$4,250.00	Balance at the end of last year is $4,250.00 lower.
Bakery Sales income statement	512,640.25 Cr	508,390.25 Cr	$4,250.00	Last year's profit is $4,250.00 lower because of this account.

Last year's profit and retained earnings

	YOUR FINAL	BOOKS TODAY	DIFFERENCE
Last year's profit (income less expenses)	$31,634.56	$27,384.56	$4,250.00 lower
Retained earnings at the start of last year	$117,818.50	$117,818.50	none

Check: the differences on all 33 accounts add up to **zero, as they should**.

3 ### Correcting entry, January 1, 2026 post only if the conditions below apply

Dated the first day of this year. It makes this year's opening balances agree with your final trial balance, and leaves last year's books alone.

The client's changes. Better first: undo or re-date the client's change in last year's books, which keeps the bank reconciliation and the receivable and payable lists right. Post this entry only if the changes were mistakes, the client will not undo them, and the transaction was not entered again this year (if it was, the other side belongs in this year's income or expense account, not retained earnings). If a change was right (a real bill that was missed, a deposit that really bounced), last year's return was wrong instead: consider amending it, or, if you will not amend, keep this year's beginning balance sheet as filed and show the change as a prior-period adjustment on Schedule M-2.

ACCOUNT	DEBIT	CREDIT	WHY
Checking	$4,250.00		back to last year's final
Retained Earnings		$4,250.00	the other side: last year's profit and earlier years
Total	**$4,250.00**	**$4,250.00**	**balances**

4 ### To ask the client

1. Since we finished last year's return, these balances for December 31, 2025 have changed in your books: Bakery Sales, $4,250.00 lower; Checking, $4,250.00 lower. What was added, deleted or changed, and why? Please send the transactions.

1 **The verdict first.**
Still agrees, has changed, or cannot be compared, with the effect on last year's profit.

2 **What it means.**
Each change sorted by kind, with the likely cause: here, a deposit deleted from last year.

3 **The entry, with its conditions.**
When to post it, and when to amend or undo instead.

4 **The question for the client,** ready to send.

Screenshot of the tool on test case 02 (Harbor Light Bakery, an invented client). Cropped; the full page continues with every account compared, the row each figure came from, and what was read from each file.

What comes back is a workpaper to sign: - the verdict; - every change and what it means; - last year's profit, final against today; - a correcting entry dated the first day of the new year, with the conditions for posting it; - the question to send the client.

It refuses to compare two files for different dates, cash against accrual, the wrong client, or a balance sheet passed off as a trial balance, and says why.

We tried to break it

We wrote the test first: 22 cases and 43 files across four invented companies. Seven have a planted change: a deleted deposit, a backdated bill, a 2024 purchase re-entered as an expense, a voided check, a damaged file, a distribution added after filing, and a year's meals moved into office expenses. The final version passes all 343 checks. We then broke it on purpose 18 ways. The tests caught 17. The one they missed, an export date printed above the column headings and read as the balance date, has no test file yet; it is listed as unproved.

THE TEST CAME FIRST

Every check found something

22 · 43
test cases and files, built from a ledger model before the tool

343 / 343
checks passed by the final version

17 / 18
deliberately broken copies caught; the one missed is listed as unproved

WHO CHECKED	WHAT THEY FOUND	NOW
The first test run 16 cases	Our answer key miscounted one company's accounts. The title `Trial balance, final, December 31, 2025` was read as the column headings. 10 of 16 passed.	**Fixed**
A skeptical CPA AI session told to find fault	Twelve problems. The entry could count a re-entered deposit twice; a distribution added to last year was treated as an ordinary balance sheet change; meals moved into office expenses passed as a harmless merge.	**Fixed; 6 cases added**
A first-time user AI session playing a 60-year-old partner	The warning on the entry was generic and sat under the table. Box 1 did not say which file, or that a PDF will not work.	**Fixed**
A stranger with the prompt fresh AI session, prompt only	Named the entry's accounts `1000 Checking`, not `Checking`: 18 of 22 cases. The prompt never said.	**Prompt fixed; second rebuild passes 22 of 22**

All figures from tests/RESULTS.md in the repository. Test files use invented companies; no client data.

The first run passed 10 of 16. Our own answer key had miscounted one company's accounts, and a workpaper title, "Trial balance, final, December 31, 2025", was read as the column headings.

A separate AI session, told to act as a skeptical CPA, found twelve problems. The worst: if the client deleted a deposit and entered it again in January, our correcting entry would have counted it twice. A distribution added to last year was treated as an ordinary balance sheet change, when it moves the K-1s. Meals moved wholesale into office expenses looked like a harmless account merge, losing the 50% limit. All three are fixed and now have test cases.

Another session, playing a 60-year-old partner who had never seen the tool, found the entry's warning generic and buried under the table. It now sits above the entry and says, case by case, when to post it and when to undo the client's change or amend instead.

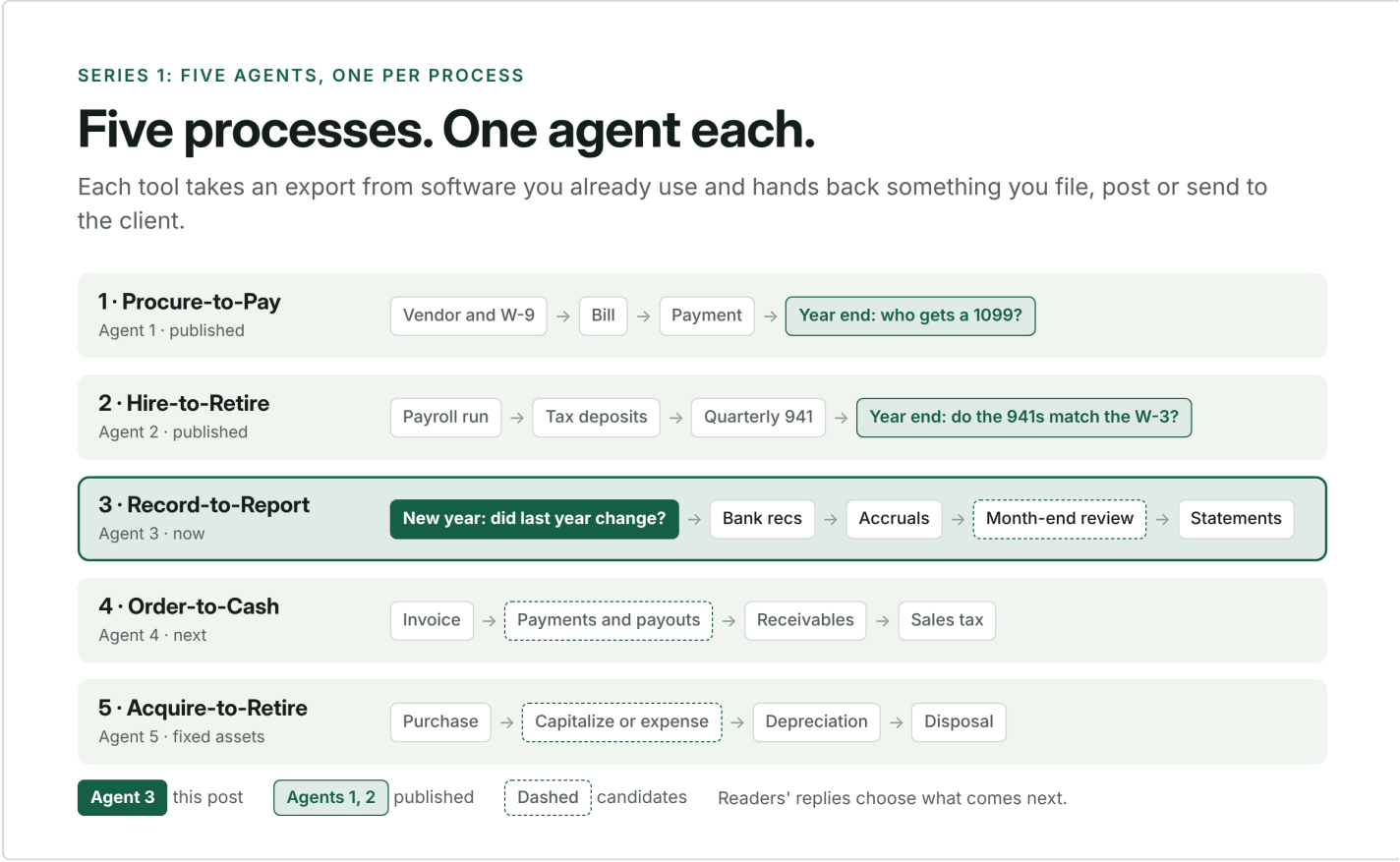
The last check was the rebuild prompt at the end of this article. We gave it to a fresh AI session with nothing else, then ran what it built through the same tests. The first rebuild passed 18 of 22: every verdict and amount was right, but it named the entry's accounts with their numbers, because the prompt never said not to. With that one line added, the second rebuild passed all 343 checks. That is what "the same agent" means here: whatever passes these 22 cases.

By hand, we estimate 10 to 15 minutes per client when nothing changed and 20 to 30 when something did, before tracing transactions in the audit log. That is an estimate, not a measurement; the next round times a practicing accountant.

What it won't do

It does not read PDFs, and it does not find the transactions: it says which accounts moved and by how much, and the audit log says which entries. It cannot tell whether a change was right. A missed bill the client added may be correct, and last year's return wrong. It does not split anything among partners, and drafts no entry when an owner's account changed. Our QuickBooks Desktop and Xero layouts were built from the products' report layouts, not from real client exports.

The series



Agent 1 found the 1099 vendors your software misses. Agent 2 checked the 941s against the W-3. This is agent 3. Agents 4 and 5 cover receivables and fixed assets. Every agent comes with its test files, its results, and one prompt that rebuilds it from nothing. The prompt is below, and everything else is at github.com/accountingnonerd/-.

Your turn

What do you still check by hand before you trust a client's opening balances? Tell me the step, the report it starts from, and how long it takes.

Appendix: the rebuild prompt, in full

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Build a single self-contained HTML file called `did-last-year-change.html`. It is a tool for a US
accountant who prepares business returns from clients' books. She is expert in accounting, impatient
with software, and works on a desktop. She gives it two trial balances for the same date (normally
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December 31 of last year): (1) last year's final, adjusted trial balance from her workpapers, the one the return was prepared from; (2) a trial balance for the same date exported from the client's QuickBooks or Xero today. It tells her whether last year's books still agree with her final figures, what changed, what it means for last year's return, and drafts a correcting entry. Everything runs in the browser; nothing is uploaded. All arithmetic is in whole cents (integers), debit positive, credit negative, in code.

Screen
- Load SheetJS 0.18.5 with `<script src="https://cdnjs.cloudflare.com/ajax/libs/xlsx/0.18.5/xlsx.full.min.js"></script>`.
- Start screen: title "Did last year change?", one sentence saying what it does, then two large drop boxes side by side (stacked on a phone), numbered 1 and 2. Each is a `<label>` wrapping a hidden `<input type="file" accept=".csv,.txt,.xlsx,.xls,.xlsm">`:
  - box 1, input `id="final"`: "Last year's final trial balance". Under it: "Your adjusted trial balance, after your adjusting entries: the one the return was prepared from. Excel or CSV. Drop it here, or click to choose it."
  - box 2, input `id="today"`: "The same date, from the client's books today". Under it: "A trial balance for the last day of last year, exported today. Excel or CSV."
  Each box also accepts drag and drop, and shows the file name with a tick once given. When both files are present, compare at once (no button). Below the boxes: how to export the trial balance from QuickBooks Online, QuickBooks Desktop and Xero; what it adds (the software lists changed transactions, this compares the books with her own final figures, including adjustments that exist only in her workpapers); a link "See it work on a made-up sample"; "Where your data goes: nowhere"; and "You stay in charge: whether to post the entry, reverse the client's change or amend last year's return is your decision." Footer: "Version 1.0.0."
- A `.pdf` file, or any other extension than xlsx/xlsm/xls/csv/txt, is refused at once with a plain message under the boxes ("... is a PDF. I can only read Excel or CSV files ...").
- Read a file with `XLSX.read`: CSV/TXT as text with `{type:"string", raw:true}` (so every cell stays a string), anything else as `{type:"array"}`. Take the sheet with the most rows, via `sheet_to_json(ws, {header:1, raw:true, defval:null, blankrows:true})`. If both files have exactly the same bytes, that is the SAME_FILE case below.
- After comparing, replace the start screen with the workpaper. Above it: one main button "Print or save as PDF" (`window.print()`) and a small "Start over with other files" link. Large type (18px or more), plain words, high contrast, light background, print styles.
- Set `window.__report` to the report object (below) after every comparison. Never leave the page blank: if anything throws, show the error under the boxes and set `window.__report = {status:"ERROR", message}`.

Reading a trial balance: readTB(rows)
Amounts
A cell is an amount if it is a number (cents = round(n*100)) or text like `1,234.56`, `$1,234.56`, `(1,234.56)`, `-1,234.56`, `1,234.56-`, `1,234.56 CR` (negative), `1,234.56 DR`. Parentheses, a leading or trailing minus, and CR make it negative; `$`, commas and spaces are ignored. Blank, `-`, en dash or em dash is "no amount". Any other text in an amount column is "unreadable".

Column headings
Classify each heading cell (lower-cased, trimmed) in this order:
1. `ytd debit` or `debit - year to date` → ytdDr; `ytd credit` or `credit - year to date` → ytdCr.
2. exactly `debit`, `debits`, `dr` → dr; exactly `credit`, `credits`, `cr` → cr.
3. Let side = Dr if the heading ends in `debit(s)` or `dr`/`dr.`, Cr if it ends in `credit(s)` or `cr`/`cr.`, else none.
4. contains `unadjusted`, `per books`, `before adj`, or starts with `books` or `book balance` → unadj (or unadjDr / unadjCr with a side).
5. starts with `aje`, `ajes`, `adj`, `adj.`, `adjustment(s)`, `adjusting entries` (optionally after `net `) → aje (or ajeDr / ajeCr).

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6. contains `final`, or starts with `adjusted`, `per return`, `balance`, `ending balance`, or is
`amount` → with a side, dr or cr; otherwise final.
7. `acct`, `acct.`, `#`, `no`, `no.`, `code`, or `account`/`acct` followed by `#`, `no`, `num`,
`number` or `code` → num.
8. `account`, `account name`, `description`, `name`, `account description` → name.
The heading row is the first of the first 40 rows that has no numeric cell, has at least two
classified cells, and has (dr and cr) or ytdDr or final. Remember the first column of each kind;
then, if there is no ytdDr and no final, use the LAST dr and the LAST cr column in the row (a
workpaper's final pair comes last).
- Mode: "ytd" if ytdDr exists (Xero: its Debit and Credit columns are the month's movement and must
be ignored), else "signed" if final exists, else "drcr".
- If no heading row is found: if the text of the first 12 rows matches `balance sheet|statement of
financial position|profit (and|&) loss|income statement|statement of operations|general
ledger|transaction (detail|list)|journal|aged (receivables|payables)|cash flows?`, it is "not a
trial balance: this is a <that> report"; otherwise "I could not find Debit and Credit columns, or a
column of final balances". If a heading row is found but the title lines above it match that pattern
and do not contain "trial balance", it is also not a trial balance.

### Rows below the heading row
For each row, until the grand total:
- The label is the name column's text if there is one; otherwise the first non-empty, non-numeric
cell left of the first amount column (skipping the number column). The number is the num column's
text.
- The amounts that count are ytdDr/ytdCr, or dr/cr, or final, by mode.
- Blank row (no label, number or amount): skip.
- Grand total: label `total`, `totals` or `grand total` (any case), or a row with amounts and no
label or number after at least one account. Record its amounts and stop reading accounts; every
later row is footer text.
- A label starting with `total` followed by more words is a section subtotal: skip.
- A row with a label and no amount is a heading: skip it, and if the label (lower-cased) is one of
revenue, income, trading income, other income, direct costs, cost of sales, cost of goods sold,
expenses, expense, operating expenses, other expenses, other expense (income statement) or assets,
current assets, fixed assets, non-current assets, bank, inventory, liabilities, current liabilities,
non-current liabilities, long term liabilities, equity (balance sheet), it starts a section that
applies to the following accounts. Remember the section's name too.
- A row whose counting amounts include unreadable text is recorded as unread (row number and label)
and left out.
- Otherwise it is an account: cents = final (signed), or debit minus credit. If the file has unadj
or unadjDr/unadjCr columns, keep the account's unadjusted amount; if it has aje or ajeDr/ajeCr
columns, keep its adjustment (ajeDr minus ajeCr). Keep the row number (1-based).
### Account labels
- `Sales (200)`: a trailing parenthesis holding up to 10 letters/digits/dots/hyphens, at least one
digit, is the code; the rest is the name.
- Split the name on `:` (sub-accounts). Each part may start with a number followed by a middle dot
`·`, bullet, hyphen, en dash or space (`10100 · Checking`, `1000 Checking`); strip it. The account
number is the number column, else the code, else the last part's number, else the first part's
number. The name is the stripped parts joined with `:`.
- Normalized name: lower case, `&` → ` and `, remove `(a/r)` and `(a/p)`, every run of characters
other than a-z, 0-9 and `:` → one space, no spaces around `:`, trimmed. The leaf is the part after
the last `:`.
### Date, basis, company
- Title lines are the rows above the heading row (each row's non-empty cells joined by spaces). The
as-of date is found in: first, a title line containing `as of` or `as at`; then any single cell
above the heading row that does not contain a time like `9:41`; then the heading cells. Never in the
footer below the total (QuickBooks puts its export date and time there).
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- Date formats: `December 31, 2025`, `Dec 31, 25`, `Dec. 31 2025`, `31 December 2025`, `12/31/2025`,
`12/31/25`, `2025-12-31`. Two-digit years are 20xx.
- Basis: `cash basis` or `accrual basis` anywhere in the title lines or footer.
- Company: the first title line that does not contain `trial balance`, `as of`, `as at`, `basis` or
`workpaper`, and contains no date.
### Checks on the file itself
- sum = the sum of all accounts' cents (0 when it balances).
- whole = at most 10% of the accounts have cents (the workpaper is in whole dollars).
- The total line ties if: signed mode, its final amount equals sum; otherwise its debit equals the
sum of the debit column as read, and its credit the sum of the credit column.
- hasAje = the file has aje, ajeDr or ajeCr columns.

## Which accounts are which
For each file:
1. Retained earnings: name matches `retained earnings|accumulated (deficit|earnings)|earnings
retained` → type RE (strength 3).
2. An account under a section heading takes that section's type, BS or PL (strength 3).
3. Account numbers follow the usual plan if: at least 80% of accounts have a number starting with a
digit; the retained earnings account (if it has a number) starts with 3; some number starts with 1,
2 or 3; and the file has no sections. Then a number starting with 1, 2 or 3 is BS, any other digit
PL (strength 2).
4. File order: find the last retained earnings row. Accounts before it are BS. After it, accounts
stay BS while their name matches
`equity|capital|draw|drawings|distribution|dividend|investment|contribution|introduced|member|partner|c
in|paid in|surplus|aaa|accumulated adjustments` and not `income|revenue|sales|fees earned`; from the
first one that does not, everything is PL (strength 1). Only accounts without a type yet are set.
5. Otherwise guess from the name (strength 0): BS if it matches `accumulated
(depreciation|amortization)|payable|prepaid|deposit|receivable|accrued|loans?|notes?|due
(to|from)|inventory|allowance|equipment|vehicles?
|furniture|building|land|cash|checking|savings|bank|undeposited|credit card|liabilit|petty` or the
owner pattern below; else PL if it matches `income|revenue|sales|expense|cost
of|fees|wages|salar|compensation|labor|guaranteed|rent|utilities|insurance|depreciation|interest|taxes|
else BS.
6. Owner account: a BS account that is numbered 3xxx under the usual plan, or sits in a section
named "equity", or whose name matches `distribution|draws?|drawings|dividend|capital (not followed
by lease, improvement, asset, expenditure)|contribution|funds introduced|investment (not followed by
income)|paid-in|paid
in|stock|shares|shareholder|stockholder|partner|member|owner|equity|aaa|accumulated adjustments`
(whole words where sensible) and not "accumulated depreciation".

## Comparing: the order matters
Status is one of AGREES, CHANGED, NOT_COMPARABLE. Each exception has `code`, `level` (stop, care or
info) and a plain-English `message`. When a step says "stop", set status NOT_COMPARABLE, list no
accounts, draft no entry, and return.
1. Same bytes in both boxes: SAME_FILE (stop) → stop.
2. Swap: if the box-2 file hasAje and the box-1 file does not, swap them and add SWAPPED (info),
naming both files.
3. Either file is not a trial balance: NOT_A_TB (stop) for each, saying which box and what report it
is → stop.
4. Both dates known and different: DATE_MISMATCH (stop). Both bases known and different:
BASIS_MISMATCH (stop). If neither of those, and at least one basis is unknown, and the final has a
nonzero account whose name matches `receivable|payable` but not
`payroll|tax|wage|accrued|loan|note|shareholder|officer|interest`, while the client's file has none:
BASIS_SUSPECTED (stop; "that is what a cash-basis report looks like"). Any of these → stop.
5. Company names both known and sharing no word of 4+ letters (ignoring company, corporation,
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incorporated, limited): COMPANY_DIFFERS (care).
6. asOf = the final's date, else the client file's date (ISO `YYYY-MM-DD`, or null). For each file:
no date → DATE_UNKNOWN (care); out of balance by $5.00 or less and whole → ROUNDING_IMBALANCE
(info); otherwise out of balance → OUT_OF_BALANCE (stop level, but keep comparing); total line does
not tie → TOTAL_MISMATCH (stop level, keep comparing); unread rows → UNREAD_ROWS (stop level, keep
comparing).
7. Classify both files. Within a file, accounts with the same number and normalized name are added
together (DUPLICATE_ACCOUNT, care).
8. Post-closing: if one file has no nonzero PL account and the other has some, the first is post-
closing. Close the other file: add all its PL accounts into its RE account (create one named
"Retained Earnings" if it has none) and drop them. If the post-closing file has no nonzero account
matching `distribution|draws?|drawings|dividend` and the other file has, close those into RE too.
Add POST_CLOSING (info).
9. Match accounts, each pass only taking one-to-one matches (exactly one candidate on each side):
(a) same account number on both sides; (b) same normalized full name; (c) same leaf. A pair matched
by number whose normalized names differ is RENAMED (info). Then, among the accounts still unmatched,
an account on each side with exactly the same nonzero balance, unique on both sides, is a guessed
rename: pair them and add RENAMED_GUESS (care).
10. If the pairs matched in (a)-(c) are fewer than half of the larger file's account count:
WRONG_CLIENT (stop) → stop.
11. For every pair, and every unmatched account (the other side counts as 0): d = today - final.
Type: the stronger classification of the two sides (the final's on a tie). Owner if either side is
an owner account. Status:
    - d = 0: "same" (or "renamed" / "renamed?" for renamed pairs);
    - else, if the final has an adjustment a ≠ 0 and |d + a| ≤ 50 cents when the final is whole (0
otherwise): "aje" (her adjustment was never posted);
    - else, if the final is whole and the client's file is not, and |d| ≤ 50 cents, or the account
is RE and |d| ≤ $5.00: "rounding";
    - else "new" (only in today's file), "missing" (only in the final) or "changed".
12. Merged: for each "missing" account g with a nonzero final balance, look for exactly one
"changed" account m with m.diff = g.final, the same type, neither an owner account, m.final either 0
or the same sign as g.final, and the two names sharing a word of 4+ letters other than expense(s),
account(s), other, general, misc, miscellaneous, cost(s), income. If found, both become "merged?"
and MERGED_GUESS (care) says profit is unchanged but last year's books no longer show the two
amounts separately, and the return's lines may no longer tie.
13. Real differences are statuses changed, new, missing and aje. Profit: NI = -(sum of PL balances),
for final and today; netIncome = {final, today, change: today - final, changeApartFromRounding}.
Post-closing: netIncome is null. Retained earnings (credit positive) = -(sum of RE balances);
retainedEarnings.change = today - final (null when post-closing).
14. Exceptions from the real differences (leave "aje" ones out of the first four):
    - CHANGED_PL (stop) for PL accounts: list them; the profit effect is -(sum of their diffs),
stated as higher or lower ("If the change is right, last year's return may need amending"), or "the
same in total, but amounts moved between lines of the return". When exactly one BS account (not an
owner account) has diff = -(a PL account's diff), name the likely cause: an income account against
an asset lower = "a deposit or sale in last year was deleted or voided"; an expense against a
liability higher = "a bill was added and dated last year"; an expense lower against an asset higher
= "a payment or check in last year was voided or deleted"; and so on.
    - CHANGED_BS (stop) for BS accounts that are not owner accounts.
    - OWNER_CHANGED (stop) for owner accounts: K-1s, Schedule M-2 and basis change even though
profit does not; correct them in last year's books.
    - PRIOR_YEARS_CHANGED (stop) for RE (RETAINED_EARNINGS_CHANGED when post-closing), with
direction.
    - AJE_NOT_POSTED (care), listing each account and its adjustment: the client posts them dated
the balance date, or she uses the correcting entry, one or the other, never both; tax-only
adjustments are left out.
```

```
    - ROUNDING (info) if any account's status is rounding.
    - TYPE_GUESS (care) for each real, merged or renamed account whose type was guessed from its
name.
    Add a sentence about payroll, sales-tax and 1099 filings when a changed PL or BS account's name
matches `wage|salar|payroll|sales tax|contract labor|subcontract|officer`.
15. The correcting entry, dated the day after asOf (null date if asOf is unknown). Withhold it
(entry null, with the reason shown) if any OUT_OF_BALANCE was raised, any owner account changed,
there is no RE account, or a real difference's type was guessed from its name. Otherwise, for every
real difference on a BS account: amount = the adjustment itself for "aje", else -d (back to the
final). The other side, -(sum of those), goes to the RE account. No BS differences: no entry. Lines
`{account, debit, credit}` in dollars (one of them 0), plus totalDebit and totalCredit. `account` is
the account's name exactly as stored after label parsing, without its number (`Checking`, not `1000
Checking`); the other side uses the RE account's name.
16. Questions for the client: the changed balances with "higher"/"lower" (no parentheses) and "What
was added, deleted or changed, and why?"; a request to post her adjusting entries dated the balance
date; "Did you merge ...?".
17. Status: CHANGED if there is any real difference or any merge; otherwise AGREES.

"Higher"/"lower" for an account: compare the change with the account's normal side (the sign of its
final balance, or today's if the final is zero); RE is always credit-normal.

## The workpaper (in this order)
- Heading: "Did last year change?", the company, the balance date, both file names; Prepared by /
Date / Reviewed by / Date lines (not when NOT_COMPARABLE).
- `<div id="verdict">`: NOT_COMPARABLE → "I cannot compare these two files."; AGREES → "Last year's
books still agree with your final trial balance." (plus what was allowed for: rounding, a renamed
account, post-closing); CHANGED → "Last year's books have changed since your final trial balance."
(or "Last year's books do not have your adjusting entries." when the only real differences are
unposted adjustments, or "Last year's books have changed: accounts were merged." when there are no
real differences), with how many accounts differ and the profit change apart from rounding.
- `<div id="stop-banner">`: visible, and listing the messages, only when there is an exception with
code OUT_OF_BALANCE, TOTAL_MISMATCH, UNREAD_ROWS, NOT_A_TB, DATE_MISMATCH, BASIS_MISMATCH,
BASIS_SUSPECTED, SAME_FILE or WRONG_CLIENT; otherwise hidden. When NOT_COMPARABLE, show nothing
after it.
- "Check these first": the other exceptions, stop first, then care, then info.
- "What changed": every account with status changed, new, missing, aje, merged? or renamed?: final
and today balances as `1,234.56 Dr`/`Cr`, the difference without a sign, and what it means in words.
- Last year's profit and retained earnings, final against today, and the check that the differences
on all accounts add to zero.
- "Correcting entry, <date>": above the table, the conditions that apply: for her adjustments, one
or the other, never both, and reverse accruals as usual; for the client's changes, undo or re-date
the change in last year first, post only if they were mistakes, the client will not undo them, and
the transaction was not entered again this year; if a change was right, consider amending, or keep
this year's beginning balance sheet as filed and show a prior-period adjustment on Schedule M-2.
- "To ask the client", then a note to set a closing date with a password or a Xero lock date.
- "Every account compared" (collapsed): number, name, type and how it was decided, both balances
with file row numbers, difference, result.
- "What I read from each file": layout, date and where it came from, basis, accounts read, whether
debits equal credits, whether the total line agrees.
- Footer: where the data went (nowhere), arithmetic in whole cents, the accountant remains
responsible.

## The report object (window.__report), amounts in dollars
```
{ version:"1.0.0", status, asOf:"YYYY-MM-DD"|null,
```
```

```
  files:{ final:{name, rows (accounts read), asOf, basis, layout, company, balances, total,
totalTies, wholeDollars}, today:{...} },
  exceptions:[{code, level, message, ...}],
  accounts:[{name, finalName, todayName, number, type:"BS"|"PL"|"RE", typeHow, final, today, diff,
status, finalRow, todayRow, aje}],   // names without numbers; name = today's name, else the final's
  netIncome:{final, today, change, changeApartFromRounding}|null,
  retainedEarnings:{final, today, change}|null,
  entry:{date, lines:[{account, debit, credit}], totalDebit, totalCredit}|null,
  questions:[...], controls:{accountsCompared, differences, rounding, roundingAccounts, diffTotal,
diffsTie} }
```

`rows` is the number of accounts read from that file before any merging or closing.

A made-up sample

Behind "See it work on a made-up sample", two small built-in trial balances: a bakery's final workpaper (with Per books, Adjustments and Final columns; a depreciation adjustment of $6,000) and a QuickBooks export for the same date in which a $4,150 deposit was deleted and the depreciation entry was never posted.